

thing Windows apps will be able to detect and accordingly adapt their UI to.

There isn't too much known about Windows Holographic yet, but given that it is Windows 10, we can assume that it will have all the features of Windows Core.

Windows as a Service

Another major change to the Windows ecosystem is that eventually it will consist only of Windows 10.

Currently the only Windows version of importance is Windows 7. Windows XP is declining and it won't be too long before it entirely disappears. Windows Vista is already a blip in the statistics. Even now Windows 8 and 8.1 make up only around 15% of OS installs; not much more than XP. Windows 8 was considered a flop and with Windows 10 out, it is unlikely that people will go out of their way to purchase it.

What this leaves us with are two operating systems, Windows 7, and Windows 10. If Microsoft's free upgrade ploy works well, at least some of the current Windows 7 users will move to Windows 10. Even otherwise mainstream support for Windows 7 has already ended, and extended support will end in another 5 years.

Windows 10 of course will still be around then, and it will still be the latest release of Windows available. Eventually, Windows 10 will be all that is left giving developers a single platform to base their applications on.

The Windows 10 core will upgrade over time, and include new features that will reach all supported Windows platforms. Windows' design is more modular now, so these updates can be asynchronous.

What this means is that unlike before, where the release of Internet Explorer, or heck even something as trivial as Notepad was tied to the release of a new Windows version, now Windows apps can keep updating like regular third-party apps via the Windows Store. The version of Edge doesn't even matter now (its 20.10240 as of this writing) as it will keep updating, and all you will notice occasionally is that it has new features. Just like any other browser.

This is where Microsoft's version of a Windows-as-a-service comes in. It's not a traditional service model where you pay monthly or yearly for a service, but one where you pay a one-time fee for a 'lifetime' of updates.

Like anyone offering a lifetime subscription, it's important to read the fine print. In this case it boils down to the following: